

Grade 1 Ontario Curriculum Foundations of Language

CVC Decoders — Grade 1 Phonics

Unit Overview: CVC Decoders — Grade 1 Phonics

Grade: Grade 1 | **Strand:** Foundations of Language

Target Expectations: B2.1, B2.2, B2.3

Learning Goal: Children will isolate, blend, and segment phonemes in CVC words and decode them in connected text.

Lesson	Lesson Title	Learning Goal
Day 1	Hear the Sounds	I can isolate and segment sounds in CVC words.
Day 2	Map Letter to Sound	I can map letters to sounds in CVC words.
Day 3	Blend the Sounds	I can blend sounds to decode CVC words.
Day 4	Read Decodable Text	I can decode CVC words in a sentence.
Day 5	Big Decoder Capstone	I can decode CVC words and read decodable text.

Lesson 1: Hear the Sounds

Goal: Spoken words are made of separate sounds. We can ISOLATE and SEGMENT them.

Expectation: B2.1

Learning Goal: "I can isolate and segment sounds in CVC words."

Materials: M1_sound_box_card, M2_picture_cards, M6_vocab_chart, M7_unit_poster

1. Minds On (12 mins): Sounder Sam's Sound Hunt

Sounder Sam: HOO HOO! Friends — every word is made of SOUNDS. Listen: /s/-/u/-/n/. SUN!

Bring children to the carpet. Hold up Sounder Sam (a stuffed animal, sock, or just gesture if no puppet). 'Reader friends — meet Sounder Sam! Sounder hears every SOUND in a word. Today we learn words are made of SOUNDS called PHONEMES.'

2. Action (25 mins): Segment 8 CVC Words

- Hand each pair a Sound Box Card, 3 counters, and 8 picture cards.
- Pairs take turns: name the picture, clap the sounds, push one counter into each box as they say each sound.
- After all 3 counters are placed, partner says the whole word back.
- Stretch: pairs identify ONLY the first sound of 4 more pictures.
- Circulate to record diagnostic.

3. Consolidation (8 mins): Sounder's Sound Brag

Discuss:

- What is a PHONEME?
- How many phonemes in CAT?
- What does SEGMENT mean?
- Show me /s/.

Exit: Each child segments ONE word: 'I heard /__/-/__/-/___/, that's ____.'
Class chants 'HOO knows the sounds?'

Lesson 2: Map Letter to Sound

Goal: Each LETTER stands for a SOUND. CVC = consonant + vowel + consonant.

Expectation: B2.2

Learning Goal: "I can map letters to sounds in CVC words."

Materials: M1_sound_box_card, M3_letter_cards, M6_vocab_chart, M7_unit_poster

1. Minds On (12 mins): Blendy's Letter Show

Blendy the Bear: Every letter has a NAME and a SOUND. The name is cee. The SOUND is /c/. Today we map letters to sounds!

Blendy the Bear joins Sounder Sam at the carpet (point to a second stuffed animal, sock, or gesture). 'Reader friends — yesterday Sounder taught us words are made of SOUNDS. Today Blendy adds LETTERS. Each LETTER stands for a SOUND.'

2. Action (25 mins): Build 6 CVC Words

- Hand each pair a Sound Box Card, a Letter Card set, and 6 picture cards.
- For each picture, pairs build the word by placing the matching letter cards in the sound boxes.
- Pairs trade roles every two pictures.
- Stretch: cover one letter and ask the partner to say only the SOUND of that letter (no name).
- Circulate to record formative.

3. Consolidation (8 mins): Sound vs Name Brag

Discuss:

- What is a LETTER-SOUND?
- Show the SOUND of /c/.
- Are they the same?
- What word did you build today?

Exit: Each child shares ONE built word: 'I built /__/-/__/-/___/, that's ___.'
Class chants 'HOO knows the sounds?'

Lesson 3: Blend the Sounds

Goal: BLEND sounds smoothly to read a word: /c/-/a/-/t/ slides into CAT.

Expectation: B2.2, B2.3

Learning Goal: "I can blend sounds to decode CVC words."

Materials: M1_sound_box_card, M3_letter_cards, M6_vocab_chart, M7_unit_poster

1. Minds On (12 mins): Sounder + Blendy Slide Together

Sounder + Blendy: /c/... /a/... /t/... CAT! When sounds SLIDE together, that's BLENDING.

Both characters at the carpet. 'Reader friends — Sounder taught us SOUNDS. Blendy taught us LETTERS make sounds. Today we learn to BLEND — slide sounds together to read a whole word.'

2. Action (25 mins): Blend 10 Words

- Hand each pair a Sound Box Card, a Letter Card set, and 10 word slips.
- For each word slip, pairs build the word with letter cards in the sound boxes, then point and sound each letter, then slide to read.
- Pairs alternate: one builds, one reads, then swap.
- Last 5 word slips are NEW words.
- Circulate to record formative.

3. Consolidation (8 mins): Blendy's Blend Brag

Discuss:

- What does BLEND mean?
- Show the blend gesture for CAT.
- What new word did you read today?
- Why do we slide sounds together?

Exit: Each child blends ONE new word out loud: '/___/-/___/-/___/, that's ___!' Class chants 'HOO knows the sounds?'

Lesson 4: Read Decodable Text

Goal: Apply DECODING to read short sentences with CVC words.

Expectation: B2.3

Learning Goal: "I can decode CVC words in a sentence."

Materials: M2_picture_cards, M4_decodable_strips, M6_vocab_chart, M7_unit_poster

1. Minds On (12 mins): Sounder + Blendy Read Together

Sounder + Blendy: Today we put words into SENTENCES. Read each word. Keep going!

Both characters at the carpet. 'Reader friends — yesterday we blended one word at a time. Today we read SENTENCES with many CVC words. We DECODE each word, then keep going.'

2. Action (25 mins): Read 6 Decodable Sentences

- Hand each pair 6 sentence strips and 1 pointer.
- For each strip, pairs take turns: one points and reads, the other listens and helps if needed.
- After all 6 strips, pairs pick their favourite sentence and read it once more, smoothly.
- Stretch: pairs add ONE word to a sentence (write it on a sticky note) and re-read.
- Circulate to record formative.

3. Consolidation (8 mins): Decode Brag

Discuss:

- What does DECODE mean?
- What did you do when you met a tricky word?
- What is your favourite sentence today?
- Why do we re-read?

Exit: Each child reads ONE sentence aloud.

Lesson 5: Big Decoder Capstone

Goal: Decoders HEAR sounds, MAP letters, BLEND, and READ.

Expectation: B2.1, B2.2, B2.3

Learning Goal: "I can decode CVC words and read decodable text."

Materials: M1_sound_box_card, M2_picture_cards, M3_letter_cards, M4_decodable_strips

1. Minds On (10 mins): Sounder + Blendy's 4-Stop Tour

Sounder + Blendy: Today is the BIG DECODER day! 4 stations, 4 jobs: HEAR, MAP, BLEND, READ.

Both characters at the carpet. 'Reader friends — you are now DECODERS! In 4 days you learned 4 jobs. Today you do all 4 at 4 stations.'

2. Action (28 mins): The Big Decoder Tour

- Hand out Capstone Templates.
- Station 1 (HEAR): pick 2 pictures, segment into 3 sounds, mark on template.
- Station 2 (MAP): match 4 letter cards to phoneme bubbles on the template.
- Station 3 (BLEND): build 2 CVC words in sound boxes; write them on the template.
- Station 4 (READ): read 2 decodable sentence strips; circle CVC words on the template.
- Circulate to record summative evidence on the rubric.

3. Consolidation (7 mins): Decoder Brag Circle

Discuss:

- What was YOUR favourite job today?
- Which station felt easiest?
- Which station felt trickiest?
- What is one new word you decoded?

Exit: Each child shares ONE: 'I decoded ___ today.' Class chants 'HOO knows the sounds?'

Name: _____

Date: _____

Sounder's Sound Hunt

Learning Goal: I can isolate and segment sounds in CVC words.

Instructions for the Student:

1. Draw a line from each picture to its FIRST sound.
2. For 4 pictures, write ONE sound in each box.
3. For 3 pictures, circle the LAST sound you hear.

Sound Boxes

Write one sound in each box.

PIN

--	--	--

CUP

--	--	--

RUN

--	--	--

LID

--	--	--

Name: _____

Date: _____

Blendy's Letter Build

Learning Goal: I can map letters to sounds in CVC words.

Instructions for the Student:

1. Draw a line from each letter to its SOUND.
2. For 4 pictures, write the letter that makes each sound.
3. Read each word in the sound boxes.

Read and Match

Read each word. Circle the matching picture.

p	i	n
---	---	---

PIN

PEN

PAN

c	u	p
---	---	---

CAP

CUP

COP

r	u	n
---	---	---

RAN

RUN

RIN

Name: _____

Date: _____

Sounder + Blendy Slide

Learning Goal: I can blend sounds to decode CVC words.

Instructions for the Student:

1. For 4 words, sound each letter and SLIDE the sounds together.
2. Read each word.
3. Read 2 NEW words and write each one on the line.

Word to Picture

Read each word. Draw a line to its picture.

d	o	g
---	---	---

DOG

p	i	n
---	---	---

PIN

c	u	p
---	---	---

CUP

b	a	g
---	---	---

BAG

Name: _____

Date: _____

Read with Sounder + Blendy

Learning Goal: I can decode CVC words in a sentence.

Instructions for the Student:

1. Read each sentence.
2. Read each sentence.
3. Pick a CVC word from the box.

Sentence to Picture

Read each sentence. Match it to its picture.

A pig in a hat.

PIG + HAT

The dog sat on a bed.

DOG + BED

A cat on a bus.

CAT + BUS

Name: _____

Date: _____

Big Decoder Capstone

Learning Goal: I can decode CVC words and read decodable text.

Instructions for the Student:

1. For 2 pictures, segment the word into 3 sounds and write a letter for each sound.
2. Read each sound-box word.
3. Read each sentence.

Read a Sentence

Read each sentence. Circle the CVC words.

The pig sat in a hat.

A bus on the mat.

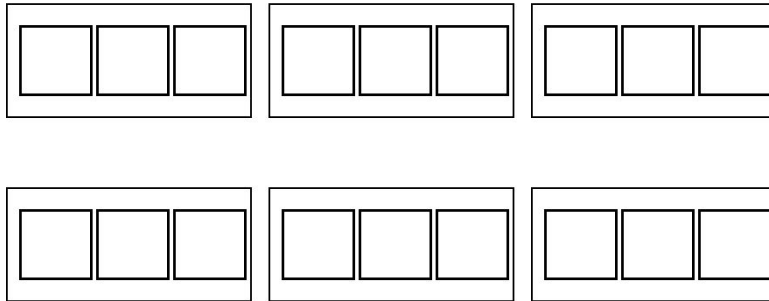
3-Box Sound Box Card

(M1_sound_box_card)

Index card with 3 boxes drawn in marker.

3-Box Sound Box Cards

Print 5 pages. Cut into 6 cards per page.



PRINT SPECS

Size: letter landscape

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 5 pages.

2. Cut into 6 cards per page.

3. Laminate (optional).

4. Distribute one card per pair.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 30 cards

Lessons: 1, 2, 3, 5

Prep: ~15 min

CVC Picture Cards

(M2_picture_cards)

20 picture cards for the unit's CVC vocabulary.

CVC Picture Cards

Print 10 sets. Cut into 20 cards.

CAT	DOG	SUN	MAT	PIN
CUP	RUN	LID	BAG	FOX
JET	HAT	TOP	WEB	PIG
MOP	BED	BUS	SIT	PEN

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 2

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 10 sets.

2. Cut into 20 cards per set.

3. Laminate (optional).

4. Store in labelled bag per pair.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 10 sets

Lessons: 1, 4, 5

Prep: ~20 min

Letter Index Cards

(M3_letter_cards)

26 lowercase letter cards.

Letter Index Cards

Print 10 sets. Cut into 26 cards.

a	b	c	d	e	f	g
h	i	j	k	l	m	n
o	p	q	r	s	t	u
v	w	x	y	z		

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 2

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 10 sets.

2. Cut into 26 cards per set.

3. Laminate (optional).

4. Store in labelled bag per pair.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 10 sets

Lessons: 2, 3, 5

Prep: ~20 min

Decodable Sentence Strips

(M4_decodable_strips)

6 short sentences using CVC + heart words.

Decodable Sentence Strips

Print 10 sets. Cut into 6 strips.

The cat sat on a mat.

Pat the dog.

A pig in a hat.

The bus is red.

A pen on the bed.

The fox ran.

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 10 sets.

2. Cut into 6 strips per set.

3. Laminate (optional).

4. Store in labelled bag per pair.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 10 sets

Lessons: 4, 5

Prep: ~12 min

Big Decoder Capstone Template

(M5_capstone_template)

Letter-size template with 4 station response areas.

Big Decoder Capstone

HEAR · MAP · BLEND · READ

1 HEAR Segment 2 picture words into 3 sounds.	2 MAP Match 4 letter cards to phoneme bubbles.
3 BLEND Build and read 2 CVC words.	4 READ Decode 2 sentences. Circle CVC words.

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: no

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 25 templates.

2. Stack near teacher table.

3. No lamination — children write on it.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 25 templates

Lessons: 5

Prep: ~5 min

Phonics Vocabulary Chart

(M6_vocab_chart)

Anchor chart with 5 unit terms.

Phonics Words

Anchor chart for the unit.

phoneme	A sound in a spoken word.
segment	Break a word into separate sounds.
letter-sound	The sound a letter makes.
blend	Slide sounds together: /c/-/a/-/t/ → cat.
decode	Use letter-sounds to read a word.

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 copy.

2. Laminate.

3. Tape to front wall before Lesson 1.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 chart

Lessons: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5

Prep: ~10 min

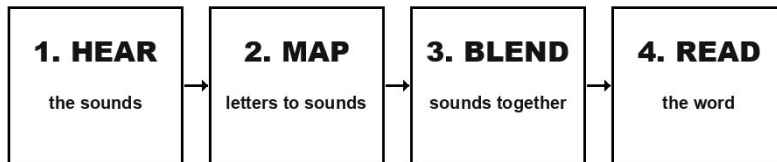
CVC Decoders Poster

(M7_unit_poster)

Unit anchor poster of Sounder + Blendy with the 4-step decoder process.

CVC Decoders

Sounder Sam + Blendy the Bear



HOO knows the sounds? YOU do!

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter landscape

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 copy on letter or 11x17.

2. Laminate.

3. Tape to front wall on Day 1.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 poster

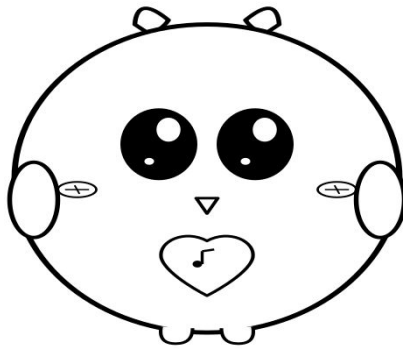
Lessons: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5

Prep: ~10 min

Sounder Sam Puppet

(char_sounder_puppet)

Paper puppet of Sounder Sam the Owl for teacher use in all 5 lessons.



Sounder Sam the Owl

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 copy.

2. Cut around silhouette and tab.

3. Laminate.

4. Glue popsicle stick or attach to a sock.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 puppet

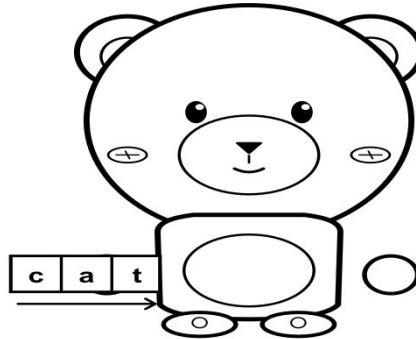
Lessons: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5

Prep: ~12 min

Blendy Puppet

(char_blendy_puppet)

Paper puppet of Blendy the Bear for teacher use in Lessons 2-5.



Blendy the Bear

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 copy.

2. Cut around silhouette and tab.

3. Laminate.

4. Glue popsicle stick or attach to a sock.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 puppet

Lessons: 2, 3, 4, 5

Prep: ~12 min

Name: _____

Date: _____

Summative Assessment Rubric

Expectation	Level 1 (Beginning)	Level 2 (Developing)	Level 3 (Achieving)	Level 4 (Exceeding)
B2.1 demonstrate phonemic awareness by manipulating...	Cannot isolate or segment phonemes.	Isolates first sound with prompts.	Independently isolates first and last sounds and segments CVC words into 3...	Manipulates phonemes (substitutes, deletes) and explains the difference...
B2.2 apply foundational knowledge of letter-sound...	Says letter names instead of sounds.	Maps some letters to sounds with prompts.	Independently maps all single letters in a CVC word to their sounds.	Articulates name-vs-sound distinction and applies letter-sound knowledge to a...
B2.3 decode unfamiliar words containing one syllable,...	Cannot decode CVC words.	Decodes known CVC words with prompts.	Independently decodes new CVC words by blending phonemes smoothly.	Re-reads for sense and self-corrects.

Junior Decoder Certificate (G1)

This certificate is proudly presented to:

For successfully completing the 5-Day G1 CVC Decoders unit and demonstrating the skills of a Junior Decoder. Sounder Sam the Owl and Blendy the Bear congratulate the student.

By completing this unit, this student has demonstrated:

- Hearing and segmenting phonemes
- Mapping letters to sounds
- Blending sounds to read CVC words
- Decoding CVC words in connected text

Marketplace Listing

A 5-day Grade 1 phonics unit on decoding CVC words framed around Sounder Sam the Owl and Blendy the Bear.

Price: \$8.99 CAD

Pages: ~38

Classroom time: 225 min

Teacher prep: ~120 min

Top tags: Grade 1, language, phonics, Science of Reading, phonemic awareness, decoding, CVC, Ontario curriculum 2023

What's included:

- Unit blueprint (1 file)
- 5 lesson plans (5 files)
- 5 worksheets (5 files)
- Manipulatives plan (1 file)
- Formative + reflection (1 file)
- Assessment suite (1 file)